KSE Partner-Student Visits Olin and Heralds the Launch of Delta Engineering

In September, the Kyiv School of Economics (KSE) will welcome their first class of undergraduate engineering students. With just two months to go, the Delta Engineering team is working around the clock to set the stage.

While Delta faculty are taking student applications and finalizing courseware for the fall semester, Ihor Protsenko is putting himself in the shoes of the incoming students. By visiting Olin, he lays the groundwork for collaboration and cultural exchange.

Ihor is a partner-student for KSE's new Delta Engineering program in Ukraine. He and seven other partner-students previously visited Olin for three weeks in October 2025. Since then, he has traveled internationally and networked to increase and diversify the support for Delta Engineering.

Round-Table Topics

On June 18, 2026, Ihor met with a round table of Olin students, faculty, and staff in the Olin Library. They chatted over lunch and into the afternoon.

First, Ihor presented the latest updates from the Delta faculty. Since their last visit, Delta faculty have created curricula for the first year and beyond. They're now comparing course schedules with each other to ensure that Delta students will have a consistent workload across their first semester. With coaching from Olin faculty, they're designing experiences, not just syllabi, for incoming students.

Delta faculty are also recruiting prospective students, hosting challenge days (their equivalent of Candidates' Weekends), and



Olin Students and Ihor (front right), equipped with pizza and a whiteboard. Photo by Timur Gray.

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hosting open houses. In Ukraine, prospective students have until July 31 to submit their college applications. Delta Engineering won't have an official student list until August. They anticipate an incoming class of about thirty students after a competitive application process.

The bulk of the round-table conversation on June 18 covered strategies for collaboration and cultural exchange between Olin students and Delta students. Of course, they recognized, reality will depend on the incoming students' interests. For example, they discussed how to establish the following relationships:

- Olin clubs, like Olin Electric Motorsports, can welcome the remote presence of Delta students. Delta students can learn from Olin club leaders and go on to establish their own clubs.

- Olin students and Delta students can collaborate in passionate pursuits. Ihor shared an example of current KSE students (that is, in one of their Master's programs) who designed autonomous robots with Kyiv firefighters.

- Delta students and Olin students can host virtual meet-ups for semi-structured conversations about student life and engineering for impact.

- Olin students can gain access to Ukrainian test users, project collaborators, and companies.

A Unique Partnership

The emphasis on remote collaboration stems from the fact that Olin students cannot travel to Kyiv due to the ongoing war.

The lack of in-person cultural exchange poses a unique challenge for the Olin-KSE partnership. The Olin educational model is more than just a project-based curriculum; it also depends on social elements like peer-to-peer teaching, student engagement, and spontaneity. In past partnerships, like the historic Olin-Insper partnership, Olin students directly helped set the tone of the program. For reference, Olin sent over a dozen students to Insper Faculdade in São Paulo, Brazil across two years.

The Olin model is not plug-and-play, and every partner program faces unique challenges. Ihor's in-person visit is an example of how KSE and Olin are pioneers of engineering education and why they have been shortlisted for the 2026 PIEoneer Awards Partnership of the Year. Ihor's work will have an impact when the fall semester starts, with an intercollegiate network already in place.

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On behalf of KSE-Olin partnership principals
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